

CS 253 longest-palindrome problem

You are given S , a string of length N . You get a subsequence by deleting zero or more letters from S . You want to find a longest subsequence of S which is a palindrome. That is, it equals its own reversal.

If there are multiple solutions, you prefer the leftmost subsequence. That is, you want a subsequence whose first symbol is as far left as possible in S . Among those solutions with the same first symbol, you want the second symbol to be as far left as possible, and so on.

Remark: for most of the test cases, N is at most 5000, and a well-written quadratic time solution should suffice. For the last test (worth 5%) N is 40000, but the number of deletions needed to get the subsequence is at most 10, so you could try to handle that as a special case (some faster heuristic method).

Input Format:

The first line is a single integer N .

The second line is a string S of length N .

Constraints

$1 \leq N \leq 5000$ (except $N=40000$ in the last test)

All characters of S are lower-case alphabetic letters ('a' to 'z', inclusive)

Output Format

The first line a single integer, the length of the subsequence.

The second line is the palindromic subsequence.

Sample Input 0

9

abcabcabc

Sample Output 0

5

abcba

Sample Input 1

10

aabbbbaaaba

Sample Output 1

7

aabbbaa

Sample Input 2

10

bababbaabb

Sample Output 2

8

baabbaab

Screenshot on Hankerrank:

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Palindrome Subsequence

Problem

Submissions

Leaderboard

Discussions

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AuthorTLI41

DifficultyMedium

Max Score100

Submitted By63

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